How a bill becomes law in the Knesset

איך הצעת חוק הופכת לחוק בכנסת

120 members, four readings at most, one flow chart. Here is the path every Israeli law takes.

120 חברי כנסת, עד ארבע קריאות, תרשים זרימה אחד. זה המסלול שכל חוק בישראל עובר.

The flow

תרשים הזרימה

Step	What happens	If it fails
0	Preliminary reading (private members' bills only): majority of voting MKs	Dropped
1	Committee prepares it, then the plenum votes: first reading	Dropped
2	Committee: detailed discussion and redrafting	Stays in committee
3	Second reading: a vote on each article	Article removed
4	Third reading: a vote on the whole bill. Majority = law	Not law

Government and committee bills skip step 0 and start at the first reading.

The facts

העובדות

- The Knesset has 120 members (MKs) elected for four-year terms.
- The Knesset is presided over by a Speaker, elected with the deputies at the first meeting of a new Knesset.
- A private member's bill goes to a preliminary reading; it passes if a majority of voting MKs support it.
- A committee prepares the bill, then the plenum votes in the first reading; if it fails it is dropped.
- After the first reading the bill goes to the relevant committee for detailed discussion and redrafting, which prepares it for the second and third readings.
- Second reading: a vote on each article. Third reading: a vote on the bill as a whole; with a majority it becomes law.
- Government and committee bills start at the first reading (no preliminary reading).
- Basic Laws are meant to be chapters of a future Israeli constitution; since 1995 the Supreme Court treats them as superior to regular laws.

Sources

מקורות

1. Knesset, Wikipedia: https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Knesset
2. How Does the Israeli Government Work?, Jewish Virtual Library: https://www.jewishvirtuallibrary.org/how-does-the-israeli-government-work
3. How a Knesset bill becomes law, Algemeiner (5 Jan 2023): https://www.algemeiner.com/2023/01/05/how-a-knesset-bill-becomes-law/
4. Reversing the Constitutional Revolution, Cohen and Shany, Israel Democracy Institute (15 Feb 2023): https://en.idi.org.il/articles/47916